

Curriculum vitae



Personal details

Name: Benjamin N. Ostendorf, PD Dr. med., PhD
Date of birth: December 14, 1983
Address: Charité University Medicine,
Dept. of Hematology, Oncology, and Tumor Immunology,
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Current positions

- 08/2025 – **Senior physician (Funktionsoberarzt)**
Dept. of Hematology, Oncology and Tumor Immunology (Prof. Bullinger),
Charité Universitätsmedizin, Berlin, Germany
- 05/2022 – **Affiliated group leader**
Berlin Institute for Medical Systems Biology,
Max Delbrück Center, Berlin, Germany
- 04/2022 – **Faculty member**
Berlin School of Integrative Oncology, Berlin, Germany
- 01/2022 – **Independent research group leader**
Dept. of Hematology, Oncology and Tumor Immunology (Prof. Bullinger),
Charité Universitätsmedizin, Berlin, Germany

Previous positions

- 01/2022 – 07/2025 **Resident physician and Internal Medicine specialist**
Dept. of Hematology, Oncology and Tumor Immunology (Prof. Bullinger),
Charité Universitätsmedizin, Berlin, Germany
- 06/2015 – 12/2021 **Postdoctoral and graduate fellow**
Laboratory of Systems Cancer Biology (Prof. Tavazoie)
Rockefeller University, New York, USA
○ Obtained PhD degree 07/2017 - 06/2020
- 11/2011 – 03/2015 **Resident and research fellow**
Dept. of Hematology, Oncology and Tumor Immunology (Prof. Dörken),
Charité Universitätsmedizin, Berlin, Germany

Education and key qualifications

- 03/2024 **Board certification in Internal Medicine**
- 11/2023 **Habilitation & *Venia legendi* in Experimental Oncology**
Charité Universitätsmedizin, Berlin, Germany
- 07/2017 – 06/2020 **PhD in Systems Cancer Biology**
The Rockefeller University, New York City, USA
- 01/2014 **Medical doctoral thesis**
Albert-Ludwigs-University, Molecular Nephrology (Prof. T.B. Huber), Freiburg,
Germany
Grade: *summa cum laude*
- 10/2004 – 05/2011 **Medical studies**
Albert-Ludwigs-University, Freiburg (Germany) with rotations at University of South
Florida (Tampa, USA), Queen Mary University (London, UK) and Mount Sinai School

of Medicine (New York, USA)
Grade: 1.0 (99th percentile, one of the 15 best exams nation-wide)

Awards and scholarships

- 02/2026 – 12/2028 **Advanced Clinician Scientist Program**
Deutsche Gesellschaft für Innere Medizin
- 01/2026 **NCT Masterclass for clinical trial design**
- 10/2022 **Best paper award for Ostendorf et al., Nature, 2022**
Charité Foundation, Berlin, Germany
- 06/2022 – **Max Eder Program of the German Cancer Aid**
- 01/2022 – 12/2024 **BIH - Charité Digital Clinician Scientist program**
Charité Universitätsmedizin, Berlin, Germany
- 12/2018 **Helmsley Fellowship**
Rockefeller University, New York, USA
- 06/2015 – 05/2017 **Postdoctoral Research Fellowship**
Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (German Research Foundation),
Rockefeller University, New York, USA
- 09/2008 – 05/2011 **Scholar of the German National Academic Foundation**
- 06/2003 **Prize for the best school leaving exam**
Christianeum, Hamburg, Germany

Memberships

- Deutsche Gesellschaft für Hämatologie und medizinische Onkologie (DGHO)
- European Society For Medical Oncology (ESMO)
- Deutsche Krebsgesellschaft (DKG)
- Arbeitsgemeinschaft Internistische Onkologie (AIO)
- Deutsche Gesellschaft für Innere Medizin (DGIM)
- Association for Cancer Immunotherapy e.V. (CIMT)

Ad-hoc reviewer

- Nature Genetics
- Nature Communications
- Nature Protocols
- Trends in Biochemical Sciences
- Cell Reports Methods
- Journal of Translational Medicine
- Bone Marrow Transplantation
- Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation
- European Respiratory Journal

Patents

- 2025 **APOE genotype in cancer prognostics**
US patent WO2020176846A3
Tavazoie SF, Ostendorf BN, Tavazoie M, Gonsalves, F

Talks (selected from last 5 years)

- 06/2026 *LXR agonism as a novel approach to incite anti-tumor immunity*
Joint Berlin – Jerusalem Symposium for Cancer Research and Clinical Oncology
- 11/2025 *PepVacc-PDAC: personalized peptide vaccination in PDAC in the palliative setting*
NCT community retreat
- 03/2025 *Liver-X-receptor agonism promotes anti-tumor immunity by enhancing T cell activation*
22nd international AEK cancer congress Berlin
- 05/2025 *Checkpoint therapy in liver cancer*
Charité Mayo Conference
- 01/2024 *Biomarkers for cancer immunotherapy*
Charité Comprehensive Cancer Center ONKO:DIALOG
- 03/2023 *Common germline variants of APOE impact COVID-19 outcomes*
The Pathologist:Webinar
- 01/2022 *Common germline variants of APOE regulate anti-tumor immunity*
Drug Discovery News series:Webinar

Publications

First and last authorships

- 2026 *Liver-X-receptor Agonism Enhances T Cell Priming and Activation to Promote Anti-Tumor Immunity*
Ostendorf BN, Goldstein JG, Liu S, Gonsalves FC, Bilanovic J, Yuan M, Kim JY, Rouya C, Tavazoie M, & Tavazoie SF
Journal of Experimental Medicine 2026;223(4):e20252290. doi:[10.1084/jem.20252290](https://doi.org/10.1084/jem.20252290)
- 2025 *BEscreen: A Versatile Toolkit to Design Base Editing Libraries*
Schneider PG, Liu S, Bullinger L, & Ostendorf BN
Nucleic Acids Research 2025;53(W1):W68-W72. doi:[10.1093/nar/gkaf406](https://doi.org/10.1093/nar/gkaf406)
- 2024 *Recapitulating the Tumor Microenvironment in a Dish, One Cell Type at a Time*
Ostendorf BN
Cell Reports Methods 2024;4(6). doi:[10.1016/j.crmeth.2024.100800](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.crmeth.2024.100800)
- 2022 *Common Human Genetic Variants of APOE Impact Murine COVID-19 Mortality*
Ostendorf BN[†], Patel MA, Bilanovic J, Hoffmann HH, Carrasco SE, Rice CM, & Tavazoie SF[†]
([†]corresponding authors)
Nature 2022;611(7935):346-351. doi:[10.1038/s41586-022-05344-2](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-022-05344-2)
- 2020 *Common Germline Variants of the Human APOE Gene Modulate Melanoma Progression and Survival*
Ostendorf BN, Bilanovic J, Adaku N, Tafreshian KN, Tavora B, Vaughan RD, & Tavazoie SF
Nature Medicine 2020;26(7):1048-1053. doi:[10.1038/s41591-020-0879-3](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41591-020-0879-3)
- 2020 *Autophagy Suppresses Breast Cancer Metastasis*
Ostendorf BN[†], & Tavazoie SF[†] ([†]corresponding authors)
Developmental Cell 2020;52(5):542-544. doi:[10.1016/j.devcel.2020.02.005](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.devcel.2020.02.005)
- 2018 *Phenotypic Characterization of Aberrant Stem and Progenitor Cell Populations in Myelodysplastic Syndromes.*
Ostendorf BN[†], Flenner E, Flörcken A, & Westermann J[†] ([†]corresponding authors)
PLoS One 2018;13(5):e197823. doi:[10.1371/journal.pone.0197823](https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0197823)
- 2016 *[Flow-cytometric immunophenotyping in clinical diagnostics]*
Ostendorf BN, Hansmann L, Ludwig WD, Dörken B, Ratei R, & Westermann J
Dtsch med Wochenschr 2016;141(21):1569-1574. doi:[10.1055/s-0042-109432](https://doi.org/10.1055/s-0042-109432)
- 2015 *Severe Radiotoxicity in an Allogeneic Transplant Recipient with a Heterozygous ATM Mutation*
Ostendorf BN[†], Terwey TH, Hemmati PG, Böhmer D, Pleyer U, & Arnold R ([†]corresponding author)
European Journal of Haematology 2015;95(1):90-92. doi:[10.1111/ejh.12400](https://doi.org/10.1111/ejh.12400)
- 2015 *Association between Low Uric Acid Levels and Acute Graft-versus-Host Disease.*
Ostendorf BN, Blau O, Uharek L, Blau IW, & Penack O
Annals of Hematology 2015;94(1):139-144. doi:[10.1007/s00277-014-2180-3](https://doi.org/10.1007/s00277-014-2180-3)

- 2015 *BCR-ABL Mutation-Guided Therapy for CML Blast Crisis: A Case Report*
Ostendorf BN[†], Nogai H, Baldus CD, Burmeister T, & Arnold R ([†]corresponding author)
Biomarker Insights 2015;10(s3):BMI.S22279. doi:[10.4137/BMI.S22279](https://doi.org/10.4137/BMI.S22279)
- 2014 *Synchronous Tuberculosis, Epstein-Barr Virus-Associated Lymphoproliferative Disorder and Cytomegalovirus Infection in an Allogeneic Transplant Recipient: A Case Report*
Ostendorf BN[†], Jehn CF, Vuong LG, Nogai H, Hemmati PG, Gebauer B, Penack O, Blau IW, Anagnostopoulos I, & Arnold R ([†]corresponding author)
SpringerPlus 2014;3(1):278. doi:[10.1186/2193-1801-3-278](https://doi.org/10.1186/2193-1801-3-278)
- 2014 *Nilotinib*
Ostendorf BN, le Coutre P, Kim TD, & Quintás-Cardama A
Small Molecules in Oncology 2014:67-80. doi:[10.1007/978-3-642-54490-3_3](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-642-54490-3_3)
- 2013 *A Novel Domain Regulating Degradation of the Glomerular Slit Diaphragm Protein Podocin in Cell Culture Systems.*
Gödel M*, Ostendorf BN*, Baumer J, Weber K, & Huber TB (*equal contribution)
PloS one 2013;8(2):e57078. doi:[10.1371/journal.pone.0057078](https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0057078)
- 2011 *Human Staphylococcus Intermedius Infection in a Patient With Postradiation Changes*
Ostendorf BN, Oehler RL, & Greene JN
Infectious Diseases in Clinical Practice 2011;19(6):426-427.

Co-authorships

- 2026 *A MERTK-Targeting Antibody-Drug Conjugate Selectively Depletes M2 Tumor-Associated Macrophages and MERTK-Expressing Cancer Cells*
Takeda S, Sridhar S, Schefer D, Andreu-Agullo C, Lo PC, Lee M, Busby R, Darst DM, Assmus A, Anaganti S, Halberg N, Ostendorf BN, Lorenz IC, Tavazoie SF, Tavazoie MF, & Kurth I
Cancer Research February 2026. doi:[10.1158/0008-5472.CAN-25-2998](https://doi.org/10.1158/0008-5472.CAN-25-2998)
- 2025 *Common Hereditary Variants of the APOE Gene and Posttransplant Outcome in Acute Myeloid Leukemia*
Ronnacker J, Grau M, Klasmeier M, Klesse C, Baldauf H, Abert S, Berdel AF, Füsser FT, Sandmann S, Albring J, Reicherts C, Call S, Marx J, Floeth M, Eßeling E, Kolloch L, Berning P, Scheller A, Wethmar K, Schmidt H, Schlüter B, Berdel WE, Ostendorf BN, Tavazoie SF, Mikesch JH, Lenz G, Fleischhauer K, Schetelig J, Stelljes M, & Schliemann C
Blood 2025;145(17):1943-1956. doi:[10.1182/blood.2024026886](https://doi.org/10.1182/blood.2024026886)
- 2024 *Neuronal Substance P Drives Metastasis through an Extracellular RNA–TLR7 Axis*
Padmanaban V, Keller I, Seltzer ES, Ostendorf BN, Kerner Z, & Tavazoie SF
Nature 2024;633(8028):207-215. doi:[10.1038/s41586-024-07767-5](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-024-07767-5)
- 2023 *Apolipoprotein E2 Stimulates Protein Synthesis and Promotes Melanoma Progression and Metastasis*
Adaku N, Ostendorf BN, Mei W, & Tavazoie SF
Cancer Research 2023;83(18):3013-3025. doi:[10.1158/0008-5472.CAN-23-1252](https://doi.org/10.1158/0008-5472.CAN-23-1252)
- 2022 *Functional Genetic Screen Identifies ITPR3/Calcium/RELB Axis as a Driver of Colorectal Cancer Metastatic Liver Colonization*
Moy RH, Nguyen A, Loo JM, Yamaguchi N, Kajba CM, Santhanam B, Ostendorf BN, Wu YG, Tavazoie S, & Tavazoie SF
Developmental Cell 2022;57(9):1146-1159. doi:[10.1016/j.devcel.2022.04.010](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.devcel.2022.04.010)
- 2021 *Functional Genomics In Vivo Reveal Metabolic Dependencies of Pancreatic Cancer Cells*
Zhu XG, Chudnovskiy A, Baudrier L, Prizer B, Liu Y, Ostendorf BN, Yamaguchi N, Arab A, Tavora B, Timson R, Heissel S, de Stanchina E, Molina H, Victora GD, Goodarzi H, & Birsoy K
Cell Metabolism 2021;33(1):211-221. doi:[10.1016/j.cmet.2020.10.017](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cmet.2020.10.017)
- 2020 *Tumoural Activation of TLR3–SLIT2 Axis in Endothelium Drives Metastasis*
Tavora B, Mederer T, Wessel KJ, Ruffing S, Sadjadi M, Missmahl M, Ostendorf BN, Liu X, Kim JY, Olsen O, Welm AL, Goodarzi H, & Tavazoie SF
Nature 2020;586(7828):299-304. doi:[10.1038/s41586-020-2774-y](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-020-2774-y)
- 2018 *LXR/ApoE Activation Restricts Innate Immune Suppression in Cancer.*
Tavazoie MF, Pollack I, Tanquedo R, Ostendorf BN, Reis BS, Gonsalves FC, Kurth I, Andreu-Agullo C, Derbyshire ML, Posada J, Takeda S, Tafreshian KN, Rowinsky E, Szarek M, Waltzman RJ, Mcmillan EA,

Zhao C, Mita M, Mita A, Chmielowski B, Postow MA, Ribas A, Mucida D, & Tavano SF
Cell 2018;172(4):825-840. doi:[10.1016/j.cell.2017.12.026](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cell.2017.12.026)

- 2015 *Myeloid-Derived Suppressor Cells in Human Peripheral Blood: Optimized Quantification in Healthy Donors and Patients with Metastatic Renal Cell Carcinoma*
Flörcken A, Takvorian A, Singh A, Gerhardt A, Ostendorf BN, Dörken B, Pezzutto A, & Westermann J
Immunology Letters 2015;168(2):260-267. doi:[10.1016/j.imlet.2015.10.001](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.imlet.2015.10.001)